lomacy was more astute and their strategy more clever—while their Home Government gave them greater support than did France to her nationals. The French made South India the base of their operations and attempted to dominate India from the south. The British following historical precedent operated from the north, after seizing Bengal, and were more successful than the French.

After going through the pages of Indian history, chapter by chapter, we can draw the following general conclusions :

(1) A period of rise has been followed by a period of decline, to be followed again by a new upheaval.
(2) The decline is the result chiefly of physical and intellectual fatigue.
(3) Progress and fresh consolidation has been brought about by an influx of new ideas and sometimes an infusion of fresh blood.
(4) Every new epoch has been heralded by people possessing greater intellectual power and superior military skill.
(5) Throughout Indian history all foreign elements have always been slowly absorbed by Indian society. The British are the first and the only exception to this.
(6) In spite of changes in the Central Government, the people have all along been accustomed to a large measure of real liberty.

II. Landmarks in British Rule in India

England first obtained her foothold in India through the East India Company. This company received a Royal Charter which conferred large powers in the matter of trade monopoly, acquisition of territory, etc. The East India Company succeeded in establishing itself in India towards the beginning of the seventeenth century as a trading concern. Gradually friction arose between the Company and the local Indian rulers of the day. And this led in some places, as Bengal, to armed conflict. During the course of one of these conflicts the then ruler of Bengal, Nawab Sirajudowla, was defeated by the combined forces of the Company and the Indian renegades who conspired against him. This was practically the beginning of the political conquest of India. A few years later, in 1765, the Emperor Shah Alam of Delhi, who was then the